

PCB-02 · BODY OF KNOWLEDGE — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The thirteen domains at a glance

The full map — thirteen domains, sixty-one knowledge areas,
three group weights

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PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.
AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

The complete map of the PCL-AI Body of Knowledge on one page: thirteen domains, sixty-one knowledge areas, and the three published group weights of forty, forty and twenty per cent. Each domain is given the question it answers and the knowledge areas that answer it, so a reader can locate any topic by number and see what sits either side of it.

— About this document

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The thirteen domains at a glance

In one paragraph. This is the complete map of the PCL-AI Body of Knowledge on one page: thirteen domains, sixty-one knowledge areas, and the three published group weights of forty, forty and twenty per cent. Each domain is given the question it answers and the knowledge areas that answer it, so a reader can locate any topic by number and see what sits either side of it. It is a reference card, not an argument.

Who this is for. Candidates planning revision, controls managers auditing what their function covers, and anyone who has been told the framework is broad and wants to see exactly how broad.

— 1. How to read the map

Every topic sits at a numbered address on the pattern **Domain.KA.Topic**. Knowledge Area 6.3 is the estimate-at-completion family inside the earned value domain; **6.3.1** is a topic within it. Cite the number rather than repeating the content — that convention lets an examination item, a revision plan and a coverage complaint all name the same place.

Weights attach to the three **groups**, not to individual domains: there is no published per-domain percentage and no per-domain passing requirement. A domain with six knowledge areas is not worth more than one with three; the counts reflect how much distinct material a subject contains, not how heavily it is sampled.

— 2. The map

Group (weight)	#	Domain	KAs
Project accounting & finance (40 %)	1	Foundations of Accounting for Project Controls	5
	2	Financial Reporting & the Standards	5
	3	Budgeting & Forecasting	5
	4	Performance Management, Variance Analysis & Management Reporting	4
Project management principles (40 %)	5	Cost Management & Cost Control	4
	6	Earned Value Management & Forecasting (EVM/EAC)	4
	7	Contracts, Commercial Management, BoQ, Invoicing & Revenue	5
	8	Project Management Lifecycle	6
	9	Agile, Scrum & Adaptive Delivery for Project Controls	6
	10	Project Scheduling	4
	11	Business Process Cycles (O2C, P2P & the control environment)	3
	12	Risk Management for Project Controls	3
AI knowledge & practical approach (20 %)	13	AI for Project Controls & PM: Concepts, Tools & Practice	7
Total	13 domains		61

— 3. Group one — project accounting and finance (Domains 1-4)

Domain 1 • Foundations of Accounting for Project Controls (5 KAs). Where do the numbers I report actually come from? A controls professional does not keep the books but reads and reconciles against them daily. The knowledge areas are the accounting model (1.1), the components of the financial statements and how they articulate (1.2), accrual accounting and the matching concept (1.3), cost provisions and accruals under IAS 37 (1.4), and the chart of accounts and cost coding that connects a posting to the work breakdown structure (1.5).

Domain 2 • Financial Reporting & the Standards (5 KAs). Which number is recorded, and when? Domain 1 gives the mechanics; this gives the rules. The reporting framework (2.1); IFRS 15 revenue from contracts with customers, the flagship knowledge area (2.2); revenue recognition beyond the basics, including principal-versus-agent and bundling (2.3); the other standards a controls professional meets — inventories, property, leases, borrowing costs (2.4); and management reporting versus statutory reporting (2.5).

Domain 3 • Budgeting & Forecasting (5 KAs). What did we say it would cost, and what do we now say? Budgeting fundamentals including the two kinds of reserve (3.1); cost estimation and its accuracy classes (3.2); the time-phased cost baseline that becomes Planned Value (3.3); forecasting and the estimate-at-completion family (3.4); and cash-flow forecasting — the difference between a project being profitable and being funded (3.5).

Domain 4 · Performance Management, Variance Analysis & Management Reporting (4 KAs). Does any of this change a decision? Performance management principles, including leading versus lagging indicators (4.1); variance analysis that decomposes a gap into price, quantity, rate and efficiency causes so the right lever is pulled (4.2); management reporting designed for an audience and a decision (4.3); and data visualisation and storytelling that informs rather than distorts (4.4).

— 4. Group two — project management principles (Domains 5-12)

Domain 5 · Cost Management & Cost Control (4 KAs). What is committed, not just what is spent? The cost management framework (5.1); the commitment-to-accrual-to-actual control cycle (5.2); the cost breakdown structure and control accounts (5.3); and change control and cost impact, where baselines are most often quietly lost (5.4).

Domain 6 · Earned Value Management & Forecasting (4 KAs). How much have we done, what did it cost, and what will it cost to finish? EVM fundamentals and the methods of measuring earned value (6.1); variances and performance indices (6.2); forecasting with the estimate-at-completion family (6.3); and integrating cost and schedule, including EVM's limitations and the earned-schedule refinement (6.4).

Domain 7 · Contracts, Commercial Management, BoQ, Invoicing & Revenue (5 KAs). Who bears the overrun, and when do we get paid? Contract types and their risk allocation (7.1); contract management across the lifecycle — variations, claims, liquidated damages, retention, bonds (7.2); bills of quantities and how work is measured and priced (7.3); invoicing and applications for payment (7.4); and revenue recognition in the commercial cycle, tying billing back to the over- and under-billing position (7.5).

Domain 8 · Project Management Lifecycle (6 KAs). Where does controls work sit in the wider job? The five process groups — initiating (8.1), planning (8.2), executing (8.3), monitoring and controlling (8.4), closing (8.5) — then development approaches: predictive, iterative, incremental and adaptive (8.6), including the incremental-versus-iterative distinction that is most often confused.

Domain 9 · Agile, Scrum & Adaptive Delivery for Project Controls (6 KAs). How do I measure work whose scope is meant to change? Agile foundations (9.1); the Scrum framework in depth (9.2); backlogs, estimation and agile metrics — velocity, burndown and burnup, flow (9.3); Kanban, Lean and scaling (9.4); agile cost control, forecasting and earned value on variable scope (9.5); and hybrid delivery and agile governance (9.6).

Domain 10 · Project Scheduling (4 KAs). When will it happen, and what has slack? Schedule development — activities, dependencies, durations (10.1); network analysis and the Critical Path Method, worked end-to-end through the forward and backward pass (10.2); schedule compression and resourcing, covering crashing, fast-tracking and levelling (10.3); and progress measurement and schedule control (10.4).

Domain 11 · Business Process Cycles (3 KAs). Which transaction created this number? Order-to-cash (11.1); procure-to-pay (11.2); and internal control and segregation of duties, including the three-way match and the audit trail (11.3). The shortest domain in the framework and among the most load-bearing: where the accounting of Domains 1-2, the cost control of Domain 5 and the commercial cycle of Domain 7 meet the daily transaction flow.

Domain 12 · Risk Management for Project Controls (3 KAs). Where does the range around every forecast come from? The risk framework, including appetite and tolerance (12.1); the risk

process — identify, analyse qualitatively and quantitatively, respond, monitor (12.2); and contingency and management reserve, which turns quantified risk into budget and closes the loop back to Domain 3 (12.3).

— 5. Group three — AI knowledge and practical approach (Domain 13)

Domain 13 · AI for Project Controls & PM (7 KAs). What can I responsibly let a machine do? AI foundations for professionals (13.1); data, the fuel that governs every AI outcome (13.2); prompting and working with generative AI (13.3); AI tool categories for controls and project management (13.4); AI applied across the controls lifecycle, the largest knowledge area, carrying the systematic per-domain workflows (13.5); governance, ethics, risk and assurance (13.6); and building an AI-augmented controls capability (13.7). The governing principle throughout is the Institute's: AI proposes; the professional disposes.

— 6. What the map does not tell you

It does not give you a per-domain weight. Coverage is spread within each group across its member domains and their knowledge areas. Any figure claiming a percentage for a single domain did not come from the Institute.

It does not confine AI to Domain 13. Every non-AI domain carries embedded coverage of how AI assists its subject and where it must not be trusted, and knowledge area 13.5 carries the systematic per-domain treatment. Governed-AI judgement can appear inside an item sitting in any group.

It does not tell you where the examination will press. Scenarios cross domains deliberately: a schedule slip carries cost, risk, commercial and reporting consequences, and one item may require all four.

It does not tell you where to spend your time. That depends on your gaps. A cost engineer from an accounting background typically under-prepares Domains 8-10; a planner typically under-prepares Domains 1-4. The map is the same for both; the revision plan should not be.

— Related

- [PCB-01 – The Project Controls Body of Knowledge – executive summary](#) — what the framework claims and what the credential asserts
- [PCB-03 – Why 40/40/20 – the weighting and what it claims](#) — why the groups carry the weights shown in §2
- [PCB-04 – What a project controls professional must know](#) — the propositions this map exists to support
- [EXB-01 – Examination blueprint – PCL-AI](#) — how the map becomes an assembled examination form
- [EXB-02 – Domain weightings and the 40/40/20 rule](#) — the sampling mechanics behind the group weights

— Sources and standards

- PCL-AI Body of Knowledge, first authored draft ([docs/bok/](#)), August 2026: domain and knowledge-area headings, and each domain's stated scope and learning objectives.
- The Style Spine ([docs/bok/00-style-spine.md](#)), August 2026: §2, the Domain.KA.Topic numbering convention; §11, the thirteen-domain map.
- Examination Blueprint ([docs/downloads/examination-blueprint.md](#)), August 2026: §2, the domain table, group weights and the two notes on reading it.

Standards named in the domain descriptions above — IFRS 15, IAS 37 and the Critical Path Method among them — are named as subjects the Body of Knowledge treats. Their principles are explained in the framework's own words at the point of use; no standard's text, table or clause is reproduced here or there.

— Status and version

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